KNOXVILLE AREA DSA

Rule on Endorsement Procedures

PROPOSED, NOT YET ADOPTED

Knoxville Area Chapter of the Democratic Socialists of America

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“The Knoxville Area DSA seeks to facilitate the transition to a truly democratic and socialist society in which the means and resources of production are democratically and socially controlled.”

STATEMENT OF PURPOSE

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Section 1. Purpose and Authority

(a) **Adoption and reservation.** This Rule is adopted under Article XVIII, Section 1(c) of the bylaws of the Chapter. Its subject, Endorsement Procedures, governing the process for endorsements and solidarity and coalition actions, is reserved to Rule tier by Article XVIII, Section 4(b) and may not be addressed by Policy.

(b) **Delegation carried.** Article XIV, Section 4 provides that definitions, submission, notice, the information session, the conduct and rescission of an endorsement vote, Steering Committee reporting of authorized solidarity and coalition actions, and endorsement records are governed by this Rule. The bylaws fix who holds the authority to act and at what threshold; this Rule is the primary source of the procedure, stating how each action is started, noticed, deliberated, voted, reported, rescinded, and recorded.

(c) **Purpose.** This Rule carries the two-track structure of Article XIV into working procedure: Track One, the membership vote that alone can make an electoral endorsement, and Track Two, the Steering Committee authorization of solidarity and coalition actions under the membership's supreme authority. It states the anti-relabeling test that holds the line between the tracks, gates all endorsement-related spending to the Treasurer's analysis under the Compliance Code, and fixes what is recorded. It is written for the member or officer who needs to know what to do and by when.

(d) **Boundary and subordination.** This Rule does not decide who holds the authority to endorse; Article XIV reserves the electoral endorsement to the membership and places the solidarity and coalition action with the Steering Committee subject to the membership override. This Rule operationalizes the bylaws and does not and cannot reduce any duty, power, right, protection, threshold, or quorum they set. In particular, it does not lower the supermajority, lower the higher quorum, shorten the fourteen days written notice, or move an electoral endorsement off a General Meeting (Article XIV, Section 1; Article VI, Section 5(b)(7)), and it does not condition or narrow the membership override of Article XIV, Section 2. Where this Rule conflicts with a higher tier, the higher tier controls and this Rule is void to the extent of the conflict (Article XVIII, Section 2).

(e) **Binding effect.** This Rule binds the membership, the officers, the Steering Committee, the Branches, the Standing Committees, the Working Groups, and the Youth Section.

Section 2. Definitions

For purposes of this Rule:

(a) **Electoral endorsement** has the meaning given in Article XIV, Section 1: support for or opposition to a candidate for any public office or a ballot measure. A candidate endorsement and a ballot-measure endorsement are each an electoral endorsement.

(b) **Solidarity or coalition action** has the meaning given in Article XIV, Section 2: formal coalition membership or formal support of a labor action. Under this Rule, formal support of a labor action includes formal support of a strike authorization, a solidarity picket, or a boycott.

(c) **Candidate** means a person who is or becomes a candidate for nomination or election to any public office. **Ballot measure** means a referendum, initiative, constitutional amendment, charter amendment, bond question, or other question placed before the voters. **Labor action** means a strike, a strike authorization, a solidarity picket, a boycott, or a comparable collective action by workers or a labor organization.

(d) **Informal coalition work** means coalition contact that involves only dialogue, information sharing, joint attendance at events, or ad hoc cooperation that creates no ongoing obligation and does not attach the Chapter's name, funds, or official position to another organization. Coalition work becomes a formal coalition membership, and therefore a solidarity or coalition action under Article XIV, Section 2, when the Chapter joins a coalition as a named or dues-paying member, commits money, staff, or its name to joint action, or binds itself to a coalition's shared positions or decisions.

(e) **Track One** means the membership electoral-endorsement process fixed by Article XIV, Section 1 and carried out under Sections 5 through 9 of this Rule. **Track Two** means the solidarity and coalition-action process fixed by Article XIV, Section 2 and carried out under Sections 10 through 13 of this Rule.

(f) **Ordinary quorum**, **higher quorum**, **majority**, **supermajority**, and **heightened action** have the meanings given in Article I, Section 4(i) through (k). An electoral endorsement is the heightened action listed at Article VI, Section 5(b)(7) and requires the higher quorum.

(g) **Member in good standing** has the meaning given in Article III, Section 2; **written notice** the meaning given in Article I, Section 4(f); **Meeting**, capitalized, the meaning given in Article I, Section 4(g). The officers of the Chapter are the two Co-Chairs, the Secretary, the Treasurer, and the Steward (Article IV, Section 1), and the Steering Committee is the body of those five officers (Article V, Section 1).

Section 3. The Two-Track Structure of Chapter Endorsement Action

(a) **Track One: electoral endorsements reserved to the membership.** An electoral endorsement requires a supermajority at a General Meeting with the higher quorum, on fourteen days written notice to the membership stating the proposed endorsement (Article XIV, Section 1; Article VI,

Section 5(b)(7)). No officer, no Steering Committee vote, and no other body or process can make an electoral endorsement.

(b) **Track Two: solidarity and coalition actions under membership supremacy.** The Steering Committee may authorize a solidarity or coalition action between Meetings of the Chapter, and the membership retains supreme authority over such actions: it may, by majority vote at the ordinary quorum, rescind, amend, direct, or itself authorize any of them (Article XIV, Section 2).

(c) **Informal coalition work on neither track.** Informal coalition work as defined in Section 2(d) requires no authorization under either track. Members may attend a picket or rally, share information, coordinate logistics, and cooperate on an ad hoc basis in their own capacity, so long as the Chapter's name, funds, and official position are not attached and the Chapter is not bound. The Steering Committee may share information about such an action with the membership and may encourage member participation, within the limits of this subsection and of Section 17(c). A subsidiary body's informal coalition contact within its scope is governed by the Rule on Subsidiary Body Operating Procedures, which routes every reserved action to this Rule.

(d) **No unilateral officer commitment.** No officer, acting alone, may commit the Chapter to any endorsement, solidarity action, or coalition action (Article XIV, Section 3; Article IV, Section 4).

(e) **No subsidiary body action.** No Branch, Standing Committee, Working Group, or Youth Section may endorse any candidate, ballot measure, coalition, or labor action (Article VIII, Section 2(a)).

(f) **Protected activity outside this Rule.** Members and factions speak and act for themselves. Organizing for shared political perspectives, caucus and faction activity, open critique of Chapter or National DSA policies and program, and participation in the democratic processes of the Chapter and of National DSA are protected by Article III, Section 4. None of that activity is an endorsement by the Chapter, none of it is an irregularity or a conflict under this Rule, and nothing in this Rule may be applied to suppress, penalize, or disadvantage it.

(g) **Nullity of contrary action.** An endorsement, authorization, or commitment made in contravention of the bylaws or of this Rule is null and void (Article XIX, Section 2).

Section 4. The Anti-Relabeling Test

(a) **The test.** A solidarity or coalition action that functions as support for or opposition to a candidate for public office is an electoral endorsement governed by Article XIV, Section 1, regardless of how it is labeled. No electoral endorsement may be relabeled a solidarity action, a coalition membership, a labor action, or anything else in order to move it from the membership vote of Track One to the Steering Committee authorization of Track Two.

(b) **Function over label.** An action functions as support for or opposition to a candidate when, considered as a whole, including its stated purpose, its target, its timing relative to an election,

and its planned communications, it operates to promote the election or the defeat of a specific candidate. A boycott, strike support, picket, or coalition campaign conducted as campaign intervention for or against a specific candidate is an electoral endorsement under this test.

(c) **Ballot measures.** Because Article XIV, Section 1 defines an electoral endorsement to include support for or opposition to a ballot measure, a solidarity or coalition action whose object is support for or opposition to a ballot measure is an electoral endorsement and follows Track One.

(d) **Application on the record.** Before the Steering Committee authorizes any Track Two action, it applies this test and records its determination in the written authorization under Section 10(e). An action this test assigns to Track One may not be authorized on Track Two, and a purported Track Two authorization of such an action is null and void (Article XIX, Section 2).

(e) **Member challenge.** Any member in good standing may challenge the Track Two classification of an action at a General Meeting, on the Steering Committee's report under Section 11 or on an agenda item under Article VI, Section 2(a), and the membership decides the classification by majority vote at the ordinary quorum under its supreme authority over solidarity and coalition actions (Article XIV, Section 2). If the membership determines that the action is an electoral endorsement, the action ends immediately and may be taken up only as a Track One proposal.

(f) **Tax classification independent.** The classification of an action under this Section decides which track the decision runs on. The classification of any related spending for tax and campaign-finance purposes is the Treasurer's separate determination under the Compliance Code, as Section 15 provides, and neither classification controls the other.

Section 5. Track One Submission

(a) **Proponents.** A Track One proposal is started by a written proposal submitted to the Secretary and signed by at least five members in good standing, or submitted by the Steering Committee, or submitted by a Standing Committee within the subject area for which it was formed. Submitting a proposal asks the membership to decide; it is not itself an endorsement by any proponent, and it does not offend the subsidiary-body bar of Article VIII, Section 2(a).

(b) **Contents.** The proposal states the subject with enough specificity that a member can tell exactly what would be endorsed: the named candidate and the office sought, or the named ballot measure; the full text of the motion to be voted; a short statement of the reasons; and the names of the proponents.

(c) **Lead time.** The proposal is submitted at least twenty-one days before the General Meeting at which the vote is sought, so that the Steering Committee can give the fourteen days written notice and organize the information session. A proposal submitted later than twenty-one days out is placed for the following General Meeting unless the Steering Committee can still meet the full fourteen days written notice for the earlier one.

(d) **Placement.** The Steering Committee places a properly submitted proposal on the agenda of the General Meeting identified under subsection (c) and may not decline to place it. It may consolidate substantially identical proposals and retains discretion over ordering and time, as under Article VI, Section 2(a). The timing mechanics of agenda placement are governed by the Rule on Meeting Operating Procedures.

(e) **One subject per proposal.** Each proposal names one candidate or one ballot measure. Where more than one candidate for the same office is proposed, each is a separate proposal and each requires its own Track One vote; the Chapter may endorse more than one, one, or none.

Section 6. Track One Notice and Information Session

(a) **Notice.** The Steering Committee gives at least fourteen days written notice of the General Meeting to the membership, and the notice states the proposed endorsement (Article XIV, Section 1). The notice identifies the subject, the office or measure, the proponents, and the text of the motion, and it is published with the certified membership count and quorum numbers required by Article VI, Section 5(c).

(b) **Information session.** The Steering Committee organizes an information session at or before the General Meeting at which the endorsement vote occurs, at which members can hear the case for and against the proposed endorsement. The session may be held within the meeting or as a separately noticed session with remote access; either way it supplements, and does not replace, the members' deliberation and debate on the floor under the parliamentary authority of Article XIX.

(c) **Optional questionnaire.** The Steering Committee may circulate a questionnaire to a candidate or campaign that is the subject of a proposal and may publish the responses with the information-session materials. A questionnaire is not required, and a refusal to answer one does not remove a proposal from the agenda.

(d) **Conflict screening.** When a proposal is circulated, the disclosure and recusal duties of the Conflict of Interest Code apply to any covered person with a loyalty tie to the subject, as Section 16 provides.

Section 7. The Track One Vote

(a) **Threshold.** The endorsement is adopted only by a supermajority at a General Meeting with the higher quorum, and no endorsement passes if attendance has fallen below the higher quorum threshold at the time of the vote (Article XIV, Section 1; Article VI, Section 5(b)(7) and 5(d)(2)).

(b) **Conduct.** The vote is taken under the parliamentary authority of Article XIX, Section 1. Each member in good standing present has one vote, proxy voting is not permitted, and remote participation and electronic voting are available by right on the same question and with the same effect as in-person voting (Article VI, Section 6(a) and 6(b)). A member may demand a division of the assembly or a recorded vote as the parliamentary authority provides.

(c) **Quorum failure and reconvening.** If the meeting convened with the higher quorum and attendance falls below it before the vote on this noticed heightened action, the meeting may recess and reconvene to complete only that business under Article VI, Section 5(d)(4), and the higher quorum must be present at the reconvened session to act.

(d) **Failure and renewal.** A proposal that does not reach the supermajority is not adopted, and the Chapter has taken no position on the subject. Renewal of a defeated proposal is governed by the parliamentary authority; a renewed proposal runs the full Track One procedure again.

(e) **Recording.** The minutes record the motion text, the certified quorum numbers, the presence of the higher quorum at the time of the vote, and the result, as Section 18 provides.

Section 8. Absence of an Expedited Electoral Path

(a) **No shortcut.** There is no expedited path to an electoral endorsement. Nothing in this Rule, and no motion, suspension of the rules, or Policy, can shorten the fourteen days written notice, lower the supermajority, lower the higher quorum, or move the vote off a General Meeting.

(b) **Venue.** Only a General Meeting, including the Annual Convention, which is a General Meeting for purposes of the bylaws (Article VII, Section 1), may take a Track One vote. An Emergency Meeting under Article VI, Section 3 and a Special Meeting under Article VI, Section 4 may not, except that a session recessed and reconvened under Article VI, Section 5(d)(4) completes the recessing General Meeting's noticed endorsement business.

(c) **Declared emergencies.** During a declared organizational emergency the Steering Committee may not endorse any candidate, ballot measure, coalition, or labor action and may not take any new public political position (Article XV, Section 3). Track Two authorization is therefore unavailable during a declared emergency. The powers of the membership at a properly convened General Meeting are not reduced by a declared emergency.

(d) **Urgent solidarity.** The lawful tools for genuinely urgent solidarity are the informal lane of Section 3(c), a Track Two authorization between Meetings under Section 10, and a standing category authorization under Section 13.

Section 9. Track One Rescission

(a) **Same procedure as adoption.** The Chapter rescinds or withdraws an electoral endorsement by the same procedure that adopts one: a written proposal under Section 5, fourteen days written notice and an information session under Section 6, and a supermajority with the higher quorum under Section 7. This standard is set by this Rule under the delegation of Article XIV, Section 4 so that an endorsement adopted by a deliberate supermajority is not undone by less deliberation than made it.

(b) **Expiration distinct from rescission.** An endorsement that expires under Section 14 ends without any vote, and its expiration is recorded, not voted.

(c) **Review between meetings.** If circumstances between meetings warrant it, including conduct by an endorsed candidate or campaign inconsistent with the basis for the endorsement, the Steering Committee may state publicly that the endorsement is under review and may suspend further commitment of Chapter funds, staff, or name to it. The Steering Committee may not replace or contradict the endorsement, which Article XIV, Section 1 reserves to the membership, and may not rescind it, because subsection (a) of this Section reserves rescission to the same Track One procedure that adopted it. It places the rescission question before the next General Meeting under subsection (a).

Section 10. Track Two Authorization by the Steering Committee

(a) **Authorization power.** The Steering Committee may authorize a solidarity or coalition action between Meetings of the Chapter by majority vote of those present and voting at a Steering Committee meeting with a quorum (Article XIV, Section 2; Article V, Section 5).

(b) **Request.** A Track Two action may be proposed to the Steering Committee in writing by any member in good standing, by a subsidiary body through its chair, or by an allied organization through the Co-Chairs as the Chapter's point of contact under the Rule on Officer Operating Procedures. The request identifies the coalition or labor action, the specific commitment sought, its expected duration, and what of the Chapter's name, funds, or obligations would attach.

(c) **Open deliberation.** The Steering Committee considers a Track Two request at a meeting open to all members in good standing (Article V, Section 6), at which subsidiary body chairs may attend, speak, and propose business (Article V, Section 1). The Steering Committee may circulate a questionnaire to a coalition or labor organization that is the subject of a request and may publish the responses with its report under Section 11; a questionnaire is not required, and a refusal to answer one does not bar consideration of the request.

(d) **Screening.** Before authorizing, the Steering Committee applies the anti-relabeling test on the record (Section 4(d)), the disclosure and recusal duties of the Conflict of Interest Code apply (Section 16), and the expenditure gate of Section 15 attaches to any related spending.

(e) **Written authorization.** Each authorization is reduced to writing and states the named coalition or labor action, the specific commitment made, any conditions, the duration or a review date, the classification determination under Section 4, and the vote. The written authorization is delivered to the Secretary for the record under Section 18.

(f) **Limits.** The Steering Committee may not authorize an electoral endorsement on Track Two (Article XIV, Section 1; Section 4 of this Rule), may not authorize any solidarity or coalition action during a declared emergency (Article XV, Section 3), and may not delegate the authorization decision to any single officer (Article XIV, Section 3). An authorization confers no expenditure authority (Section 15).

Section 11. Track Two Reporting to the Membership

(a) **Report to the next General Meeting.** The Steering Committee reports each Track Two authorization to the next General Meeting. The report states the action, the commitment, the reasons, the classification determination under Section 4, and the status of any spending analysis under Section 15, and the report is entered in the minutes.

(b) **Notice listing.** Where the authorization precedes the notice of that meeting, the Steering Committee lists the report on the agenda published with the notice, so members can prepare to exercise the override under Section 12.

(c) **Reporting failure.** The report is what places the action before the membership, but the membership's authority does not depend on it. A failure to report does not validate an authorization, does not start any clock against the membership, and does not impair the override, which remains available at any General Meeting for as long as the action continues.

Section 12. Membership Override and Direct Authorization

(a) **The override.** The membership may, by majority vote at the ordinary quorum, rescind, amend, direct, or itself authorize any solidarity or coalition action (Article XIV, Section 2). A membership decision under this Section takes effect immediately and binds the Steering Committee and every officer. When the membership itself authorizes an action, the screening of Section 10(d), the expenditure gate of Section 15, and the records of Section 18 apply, and the minutes serve as the written authorization.

(b) **Reaching the floor.** The override may be moved when the action is before the meeting on the Steering Committee's report under Section 11, may be placed on the agenda by five members in

good standing under Article VI, Section 2(a), or may otherwise be reached as the parliamentary authority provides. Because Article XIV, Section 2 fixes the vote and the quorum, this Rule adds no notice condition and no other condition to the override.

(c) **Steering Committee modification.** Until the membership has acted on a Track Two action, the Steering Committee may amend or withdraw its own authorization by the same majority vote, reported under Section 11. Once the membership has rescinded, amended, directed, ratified, or itself authorized the action, only the membership may change that decision.

(d) **No substantially similar reauthorization.** After the membership rescinds a Track Two action, the Steering Committee may not authorize the same action or a substantially similar one; only the membership may authorize it again.

Section 13. Standing Authorization of a Labor Solidarity Category

(a) **Category authorization.** So that the Chapter can act in solidarity the day a specific labor action arises, an authorization under Article XIV, Section 2, made by the Steering Committee under Section 10 or by the membership under Section 12, may cover a defined and bounded category of labor solidarity rather than a single action. An example of a sufficiently bounded category is the honoring of lawful primary picket lines of labor organizations operating in the Chapter's service territory.

(b) **Bounds.** A standing authorization may cover labor solidarity only, and the category must be defined with enough specificity that a member can tell whether a given action falls within it. It may not cover candidates or ballot measures, whose endorsement Article XIV, Section 1 reserves to subject-specific Track One votes, and any specific action that functions as support for or opposition to a candidate is outside every category by operation of the anti-relabeling test in Section 4.

(c) **Specific actions.** A specific action is taken under a standing authorization when the Co-Chairs jointly, or the Steering Committee, determine on the record that the action falls within the category. Each specific action is reported to the next General Meeting under Section 11 as if it had been separately authorized. No officer acting alone may make the determination (Article XIV, Section 3).

(d) **Override.** The membership override of Section 12 applies to the standing category itself and to each specific action taken under it.

(e) **No spending.** A standing authorization authorizes no expenditure, and the gate of Section 15 applies to the category and to each specific action.

(f) **Review.** Every standing authorization in effect appears in the annual review under Section 14(c) and continues until it is rescinded or expires by its own terms.

Section 14. Duration, Expiration, and Annual Review

(a) **Electoral endorsements.** A candidate endorsement and a ballot-measure endorsement expire when the election to which they relate, including any runoff, concludes.

(b) **Solidarity and coalition actions.** A formal coalition membership, formal support of a labor action, and a standing authorization under Section 13 continue in effect until rescinded under Section 12, or under Section 9 where the membership adopted the action as a Track One endorsement, or until the coalition, action, or category ends.

(c) **Annual review.** The Steering Committee reports to the membership at least once each year, including through the reports its five officers give to the Annual Convention under Article VII, Section 3, every active electoral endorsement, every active solidarity and coalition action, and every standing authorization in effect, so that the membership can review each of them and rescind, amend, or direct any of them.

Section 15. Expenditure Gate and Compliance Routing

(a) **No spending before the Treasurer's analysis.** The Chapter spends no money, and commits no Chapter funds, staff, or name in a way that involves expenditure, in support of any endorsement or authorized action until the Treasurer has completed the analysis the Compliance Code requires for the proposed spending. Neither a Track One vote nor a Track Two authorization authorizes any expenditure; spending follows the expenditure authority of Article XVI, Section 2 and the Financial Controls Code.

(b) **Routed, not duplicated.** The purpose-coding of expenditures, the classification of activity as political campaign intervention, the internal alerts and caps on that activity, and every federal and Tennessee filing, registration, and reporting determination are governed by the Compliance Code under the delegations of Article XVI, Section 5, Article XVII, Section 3, and Article XVIII, Section 4(a). This Rule sets no benchmark, no cap, and no filing rule.

(c) **The Treasurer's determination.** The classification of an endorsement and of any related spending for tax and campaign-finance purposes is the Treasurer's determination under the Compliance Code (Article IV, Section 6). As a general orientation only, candidate-related spending is ordinarily political campaign intervention, while ballot-measure, coalition, and labor-solidarity activity is ordinarily social welfare activity or lobbying; the controlling classification is made under the Compliance Code.

(d) **Registration-threshold escalation.** If the Treasurer determines that a proposed expenditure would require political campaign committee or political action committee registration, a separate segregated fund, or a federal political-organization filing, the matter is brought to the

membership, and a review of the Compliance Code is begun, before any such expenditure is made.

Section 16. Conflict of Interest Routing

(a) **Disclosure and recusal.** A covered person under the Conflict of Interest Code who has a loyalty tie to the subject of a proposed endorsement or Track Two action, including a position as a leader, officer, director, employee, or candidate of, or a close personal relationship with a leader of, the organization or campaign that is the subject of the decision, discloses and recuses as that Code requires.

(b) **Protected activity not a conflict.** Membership in a caucus, faction, working group, or political tendency and the democratic activity protected by Article III, Section 4 are never a conflict of interest and never a basis for recusal under this Rule.

(c) **No restatement.** The disclosure and recusal mechanics stay in the Conflict of Interest Code, and this Rule adds none and reduces none.

Section 17. Public Communication of Endorsement Action

(a) **Spokespersons.** An adopted endorsement and an authorized solidarity or coalition action are communicated on the Chapter's behalf by its spokespersons under Article IV, Section 8 and the Rule on Officer Operating Procedures.

(b) **Within the terms adopted.** A public communication stays within the terms the membership adopted or the authorizing body approved and identifies the position as the Chapter's.

(c) **No unadopted endorsement.** No officer, body, or member may state or imply an endorsement, solidarity action, or coalition commitment of the Chapter that has not been adopted or authorized under Article XIV and this Rule (Article XIV, Section 3; Article XIX, Section 2).

Section 18. Endorsement Records

(a) **Records kept.** The Chapter keeps, for each matter under this Rule: the proposal or request; the meeting notice; the information-session materials and any questionnaire and responses; the written Track Two authorization and each report under Section 11; each classification determination and any membership decision on a challenge under Section 4(e); each standing authorization and each on-the-record determination under Section 13(c); each under-review statement under Section 9(c); and the minutes recording each vote, with the motion text, the quorum certification, and the result. The minutes recording a Track One vote, a Track Two

authorization or override, or a rescission are governance records in the Secretary's custody (Article IV, Section 5).

(b) **The endorsement record.** The Secretary maintains a current endorsement record, an Artifact under Article XVIII, Section 8, listing every active electoral endorsement, solidarity and coalition action, and standing authorization, with its adoption or authorization date and its expiration or review date. The record implements this Rule, binds no one on its own, and is corrected to the minutes whenever they differ.

(c) **Retention and handling.** Retention periods and disposition are governed by the Document Retention Code, classification and disclosure by the Rule on Records Classification and Public Disclosure, and platform, access controls, and security by the Information Security Code, under Article XVII, Section 3. This Rule sets no retention period and selects no platform.

Section 19. Relationship to the Bylaws and Sibling Instruments

(a) **Bylaws.** Article XIV fixes the authority: the electoral endorsement reserved to the membership with the anti-relabeling rule (Section 1), the Steering Committee's solidarity and coalition authorization under the membership override (Section 2), the bar on unilateral officer commitment (Section 3), and the delegation of procedure to this Rule (Section 4). Article VI, Section 5(b)(7) lists the electoral endorsement among the heightened actions requiring the higher quorum. This Rule restates those provisions only to operationalize them and reduces none of them; where it conflicts with a higher tier it is void to the extent of the conflict (Article XVIII, Section 2).

(b) **Compliance Code.** The Compliance Code owns primary-purpose tracking, the classification of political campaign intervention, and every filing, registration, and reporting determination. Section 15 gates spending to that Code and adds no rule of its own.

(c) **Financial Controls Code.** Expenditure thresholds, signatures, and disbursement controls stay in the Financial Controls Code under Article XVI; a vote or authorization under this Rule never substitutes for them.

(d) **Conflict of Interest Code.** That Code owns disclosure and recusal; Section 16 routes to it and restates nothing.

(e) **Rule on Subsidiary Body Operating Procedures.** That Rule governs a subsidiary body's informal coalition contact and routes every reserved endorsement action to this Rule; the hard bar itself is Article VIII, Section 2(a).

(f) **Rule on Officer Operating Procedures.** That Rule governs spokesperson and coalition-liaison mechanics, subject to Article XIV, Section 3 and to Section 17 of this Rule.

(g) **Rule on Meeting Operating Procedures.** That Rule governs agenda-petition timing and the notice and conduct of Emergency and Special Meetings; nothing in it can create an endorsement venue this Rule and Article XIV do not allow.

(h) **Code on Election Procedures.** That Code governs the Chapter's internal elections of officers, Harassment Grievance Officers, and delegates. It does not govern the endorsement of external candidates or ballot measures, and this Rule does not touch internal election mechanics.

(i) **National DSA.** The Chapter's governance instruments are subordinate to the national documents, which control in any conflict (Article II, Section 2). National DSA's own endorsement criteria and processes govern national endorsements and do not displace the Chapter procedure in this Rule, and the Chapter takes no endorsement action prohibited by a resolution of the National Convention or the National Political Committee.